IT Website: Classes, Files and Functions Guide

PCCOE Department of Information Technology website · 31 Oct 2026

How the site is put together

The home page is one short file, `index.php`, that pulls in about ten smaller PHP files in order. Each piece of the page lives in its own file, so you edit one part without touching the rest.

When someone opens the site, `index.php` runs these steps top to bottom:

1. `includes/config.php` loads contact details, the main menu list and the helper functions.
2. `components/ui.php` loads reusable building blocks such as `section_title()`.
3. It sets the page settings: `$currentPage`, `$pageTitle`, `$pageDescription`, `$pageStyles`.
4. `includes/head.php` prints the `<head>`: title, fonts, Font Awesome, Bootstrap and the CSS files.
5. `includes/header.php` prints the top strip, the college logo header, the main menu and the Spotlight ticker.
6. The six files in `sections/home/` print the page sections inside `<main>`.
7. `includes/footer.php` prints the footer, the back-to-top button, the search pop-up and the JavaScript files.

Folder or file	What it holds
`index.php`	The home page: only the list of parts above
`includes/`	Parts every page shares: config, head, header, footer
`components/ui.php`	Small reusable elements (functions)
`sections/home/`	One file per home page section; its text is at the top
`assets/css/style.css`	Global styles + header and footer (Computer dept design)
`assets/css/home.css`	Styles used only on the home page
`assets/js/main.js`	Menu, search, animations, notices scroll, pop-up
`assets/vendor/bootstrap/`	Bootstrap 5.3.3, stored in the project
`assets/images/`	Photos and logos
`.htaccess`	Lets `/hod` open `hod.php` on an Apache server
`router.php`	Same thing for the local preview `php -S localhost:8000 router.php`
`build.php` + `netlify.toml`	Turn the PHP pages into plain HTML for Netlify

PHP: includes, variables and functions

The PHP only assembles the page; there is no database. Content sits in PHP arrays at the top of each file, and a `foreach` loop prints one block of HTML per item.

Variables a page sets before the includes

Variable	Set in	Used for
`$currentPage`	`index.php`	Which menu item is highlighted (`'index'` for home)

Variable	Set in	Used for
`$pageTitle`	`index.php`	Browser tab text
`$pageDescription`	`index.php`	Search engine summary
`$pageStyles`	`index.php`	Extra CSS files for this page (`home.css`)
`$pageScripts`	optional	Extra JS files for this page

Shared settings in `includes/config.php`

Name	What it is
`SITE_ROOT`	The project folder, used to check whether a file exists
`LIVE_SITE`	`https://it.pccoepune.com`, for pages not rebuilt yet
`$SITE`	Contact details: phones, emails, address, enquiry form, map
`$NAV_MENU`	The whole main menu: each item has `label` and `page` (or `url`), dropdowns have `items`

Helper functions

Function	File	What it does
`e($text)`	config.php	Makes text safe to print in HTML (wraps `htmlspecialchars`)
`page_url($page)`	config.php	Gives the link to a page: `hod` if `hod.php` exists, otherwise the official site's `/hod`
`nav_link_attrs($item)`	config.php	Builds `href` for a menu item, plus `target="_blank"` for other websites
`external($url)`	config.php	Link attributes that open another website in a new tab
`live_file($path)`	config.php	Link to a PDF or image still stored on it.pccoepune.com
`nav_is_active($item, $currentPage)`	header.php	True when a menu item matches the current page
`section_title($eyebrow, $title, $subtitle, $align)`	components/ui.php	Prints a section heading with the gold underline
`action_button($label, $href, ...)`	components/ui.php	Prints a rounded button link (ready for later pages)

Content arrays in `sections/home/`

File	Arrays
`hero-notices.php`	`$slides` (photo + caption), `$news` (notices)
`about.php`	`$documents` (Mandatory Disclosure, PCET Brochure)
`dept-glance.php`	`$glanceCards` (3 cards)
`testimonials.php`	`$testimonials`, `$importantLinks`
`honours-video.php`	`$honoursCourses`, `$eventBanner`
`popup.php`	`$popupPoster`

The Spotlight ticker text is `$spotlight` at the top of `includes/header.php`. The PHP short tag `<?= ... ?>` means "print this".

Bootstrap 5 classes used

Bootstrap does the layout grid, spacing, sliders and pop-ups; the look (colours, cards, shadows) comes from our own CSS. These are all the Bootstrap classes on the home page.

Group	Classes	What they do
Layout	`container`	Centres content with side padding (widened to 1380px in style.css)
Grid	`row`, `col-6`, `col-md-5`, `col-md-6`, `col-md-7`, `col-lg-3`, `col-lg-4`, `col-lg-5`, `col-lg-7`, `col-lg-8`, `col-lg-10`	12-column grid; `col-lg-4` = 4 of 12 columns on large screens, full width on phones
Gaps	`g-4`, `g-lg-5`, `gap-3`	Space between columns or grid items
Spacing	`py-4`, `py-lg-5`, `mb-3`, `mb-4`, `ms-1`, `ms-auto`, `mx-auto`	Padding (p) and margin (m); `y` = top and bottom, `s` = left, `x` = both sides, `auto` = push to centre or edge
Display and flex	`d-block`, `d-grid`, `align-items-center`, `align-items-stretch`	Block or grid display; vertical alignment in a row
Sizing	`h-100`, `w-100`, `img-fluid`	Full height, full width, image never wider than its box
Text	`text-center`, `text-start`, `text-white`	Alignment and colour
Video	`ratio`, `ratio-16x9`	Keeps the YouTube frame at 16:9 on every screen
Carousel (sliders)	`carousel`, `slide`, `carousel-fade`, `carousel-inner`, `carousel-item`, `active`, `carousel-caption`, `carousel-indicators`, `carousel-control-prev`, `carousel-control-next`, `carousel-control-prev-icon`, `carousel-control-next-icon`	Photo slider and testimonial slider; `active` marks the first slide
Modal (pop-ups)	`modal`, `fade`, `modal-dialog`, `modal-dialog-centered`, `modal-dialog-scrollable`, `modal-lg`, `modal-content`, `modal-header`, `modal-title`, `modal-body`, `btn-close`, `btn-close-white`	Search pop-up, FDP poster pop-up, Swaratarang poster
Forms and buttons	`form-control`, `btn`	Search box; base button style
Accessibility	`visually-hidden`, `visually-hidden-focusable`	Text for screen readers only; the skip link shows only when tabbed to

Bootstrap's JavaScript is switched on with `data-bs-*` attributes, not our code: `data-bs-ride="carousel"` starts a slider, `data-bs-interval="4500"` sets 4.5 s per slide, `data-bs-slide="prev"` / `"next"` and `data-bs-slide-to="2"` move it, `data-bs-toggle="modal"` + `data-bs-target="#searchModal"` open a pop-up and `data-bs-dismiss="modal"` closes it.

Custom classes in style.css (every page)

`style.css` holds the colour palette, the header and footer copied from the Computer dept site, and a few extras. All colours are CSS variables in the `:root` block, so a colour changes in one place.

Colour and size variables (`:root`)

Variable	Value or use
`--pccoe-navy-darkest`, `--pccoe-navy`, `--pccoe-navy-royal`, `--pccoe-navy-mid`	Blues: #073860, #035a91, #0277bd, #0284c7
`--pccoe-navy-subtle`, `--pccoe-navy-wash`	Light blue tints for backgrounds

Variable	Value or use
`--pccoe-gold-primary`, `--pccoe-gold-bright`, `--pccoe-gold-dark`, `--pccoe-gold-soft`, `--pccoe-gold-gradient`	Gold accents: #f59e0b, #fbbf24, #b45309, a tint, and the gold gradient
`--bg-page`, `--bg-surface`, `--bg-muted`	Page, white card and grey backgrounds
`--text-main`, `--text-secondary`, `--text-muted`	Dark, body and faded text
`--border-light`, `--border-medium`	Border greys
`--shadow-xs` to `--shadow-lg`	Four shadow sizes
`--font-sans`, `--font-display`	Plus Jakarta Sans (body), Outfit (headings)
`--radius-sm` to `--radius-full`, `--transition-fast`, `--transition-normal`	Corner rounding and animation speed

Header classes

Part	Classes
Top strip	`top-strip`, `top-strip-inner`, `top-contact-info`, `top-contact-item`, `top-social-group`, `top-social-link`, `top-links`, `top-nav-link`, `top-enquiry-link`, `strip-divider`
Font size and contrast buttons	`access-tools`, `access-btn`
Logo header	`brand-header`, `brand-header-grid`, `brand-logo-left`, `brand-logo-right`, `logo-link`, `main-logo-img`, `trust-logo-img`, `brand-text-center`, `trust-title`, `college-name`, `dept-title-text`
Accreditation line	`accreditation-ribbon`, `accreditation-item`, `accreditation-sep`
Main menu	`site-navigation` (sticky bar), `nav-container`, `nav-links-wrapper` (phone drawer), `nav-list`, `nav-item`, `nav-link-btn`, `dropdown-chevron`, `nav-dropdown`, `dropdown-item-link`
Menu buttons	`nav-actions`, `nav-search-btn`, `nav-cta-apply` (Apply Now), `mobile-menu-toggle` (phone menu icon)
Spotlight ticker	`spotlight-container`, `spotlight-wrapper`, `spotlight-badge`, `spotlight-ticker-viewport`, `spotlight-marquee` (the scrolling strip), `ticker-item`

Footer classes

Part	Classes
Layout	`site-master-footer`, `footer-main-body`, `footer-columns-grid` (4 columns), `footer-col`, `footer-col-contact`, `footer-col-map`
Contact column	`footer-counter-wrap`, `footer-dept-badge`, `footer-contact-list`, `footer-contact-item`, `footer-social`
Link columns	`footer-nav-menu`, `footer-menu-heading`
Map	`footer-location-title`, `footer-map-container`
Copyright bar	`footer-bottom-strip`, `footer-bottom-inner`, `team-badge-link`
Back to top	`back-to-top-btn`

Shared extras

Class	What it does
`skip-link`	"Skip to main content" link for keyboard users
`scroll-progress`	Thin gold line at the top that grows as you scroll

Class	What it does
`mobile-backdrop`	Dark layer behind the phone menu
`search-modal`, `search-input`, `search-results`, `search-result`, `search-result-cat`, `search-result-title`, `search-empty`	The quick search pop-up
`reveal` + `is-visible`	Fade-up on scroll: add `reveal`, the JS adds `is-visible`

State classes the JavaScript adds: `active` (current menu item), `open` (phone drawer or dropdown), `show` (backdrop), `scrolled` (menu shadow), `visible` (back-to-top), `text-large` and `contrast-high` (on `<body>`).

Custom classes in home.css (home page)

`home.css` styles only the home page sections, in the same order as the page. A new page gets its own CSS file and can reuse the shared section classes in the first row.

Section	Classes	What they style
Shared section styles	`section-block`, `bg-soft`, `bg-navy`, `section-title`, `section-eyebrow`, `section-heading`, `section-subtitle`, `lead-text`	Section padding, light blue or dark blue background, heading with gold underline, small label above it
Buttons	`btn-it`, `btn-it-primary`, `btn-it-gold`, `btn-it-outline`	Rounded buttons in blue, gold or outline (used by `action_button()`)
Photo slider	`home-hero`, `hero-carousel`	Rounded slider with dark fade at the bottom and gold caption bar
Notices	`notice-board`, `notice-board-head`, `notice-all`, `notice-board-sub`, `notice-scroll`, `notice-list`, `notice-item`, `notice-icon`, `notice-text`	The NOTICES card and its auto-scrolling news list
About us	`docs-card`, `docs-card-title`, `doc-link`, `doc-icon`, `doc-label`, `doc-arrow`	Mandatory Disclosure and PCET Brochure card
Department at Glance	`glance-card`, `glance-media`, `is-logo`, `glance-icon`, `glance-body`, `glance-more`	The three cards; `is-logo` shows the whole logo on white instead of cropping
Testimonials	`testimonial-card`, `testimonial-quote`, `testimonial-text`, `testimonial-person`, `testimonial-controls`, `testimonial-btn`, `testimonial-dots`	Quote card, photo and name, arrows and dots
Important Links	`important-link`	The three link boxes beside the testimonials
Honour & Minor Courses	`course-card`, `course-icon`	Four cards with an icon and gold bar on hover
Swaratarang and video	`event-banner`, `event-banner-zoom`, `video-frame`, `video-caption`	Clickable poster, zoom badge, rounded video and its link
Pop-up posters	`poster-modal`	FDP 2026 pop-up and Swaratarang full poster, with a round close button

Section IDs, used for links like `index.php#honours-minors`: `about-us`, `dept-glance`, `testimonials`, `honours-minors`, `video-section`, plus `main-content` on `<main>`.

JavaScript in main.js

`main.js` is plain JavaScript with no jQuery. It runs nine small functions when the page loads, and each one does nothing on a page that lacks its elements. Bootstrap's own JS (`bootstrap.bundle.min.js`) runs the sliders and pop-ups.

Function	What it does	Looks for
`initStickyNav()`	Adds a shadow to the menu bar after 40px of scrolling	`.site-navigation`
`initMobileNav()`	Opens and closes the phone menu drawer; taps open dropdowns; Esc closes	`.mobile-menu-toggle`, `.nav-links-wrapper`, `.nav-item`
`initBackToTop()`	Shows the up-arrow button after 350px and scrolls to the top	`.back-to-top-btn`
`initSearch()`	Quick search pop-up; Ctrl + K opens it; filters menu pages as you type	`#searchModal`, `#siteSearchInput`, `#searchResults`, `window.SEARCH_ITEMS`
`initAccessibility()`	A+, A-, A and contrast buttons in the top strip	`#fontIncrease`, `#fontDecrease`, `#fontReset`, `#contrastToggle`
`initScrollProgress()`	Creates the gold reading-progress line	adds `.scroll-progress`
`initReveal()`	Fades sections in when they scroll into view	`.reveal`, `data-delay`
`initNoticeScroll()`	Scrolls the news list slowly; pauses on hover, focus or touch	`.notice-scroll`
`initWelcomePopup()`	Shows the FDP poster once per visit (remembered in `sessionStorage`)	`#welcomePopup`

`window.SEARCH_ITEMS` is written by `includes/footer.php` from `$NAV_MENU`, so every menu link is searchable without editing JS. Our own data attributes: `data-delay="150"` delays a `reveal` animation by 150 ms. Anyone who has "reduce motion" turned on in their system settings gets no animations.

Fonts, icons, IDs and quick edits

Fonts and icons. Fonts are Outfit (headings) and Plus Jakarta Sans (body text) from Google Fonts. Icons are Font Awesome 6.5.1 from cdnjs: `fa-solid` for normal icons and `fa-brands` for logos. Examples: `fa-house-chimney` (Home), `fa-magnifying-glass` (search), `fa-bell` (Notices), `fa-quote-left` (testimonials), `fa-brain` (AI & ML), `fa-youtube` (video). Browse more at fontawesome.com/icons.

IDs. Each one is used once per page, mostly so the JS can find an element: `mainMenu`, `heroCarousel`, `testimonialCarousel`, `searchModal`, `siteSearchInput`, `searchResults`, `welcomePopup`, `eventBannerModal`, `fontDecrease`, `fontReset`, `fontIncrease`, `contrastToggle`.

Quick edits

I want to...	Edit
Add a news item	`$news` in `sections/home/hero-notices.php` (newest first)
Change a menu link	`$NAV_MENU` in `includes/config.php`
Change phone, email or address	`$SITE` in `includes/config.php`
Change the Spotlight ticker	`$spotlight` in `includes/header.php`
Change a colour everywhere	`:root` in `assets/css/style.css`
Fade something in on scroll	Add `class="reveal"` to it
Add a new page	Create `pagename.php` like `index.php`, with its sections in `sections/pagename/`